

# Single-Label Multi-Modal Field of Research Classification



Universität  
Zürich<sup>UZH</sup>



Dynamic and Distributed  
Information Systems

Florian Ruosch\*, Rosni Vasu\*, Ruijie Wang,

Luca Rossetto, and Abraham Bernstein

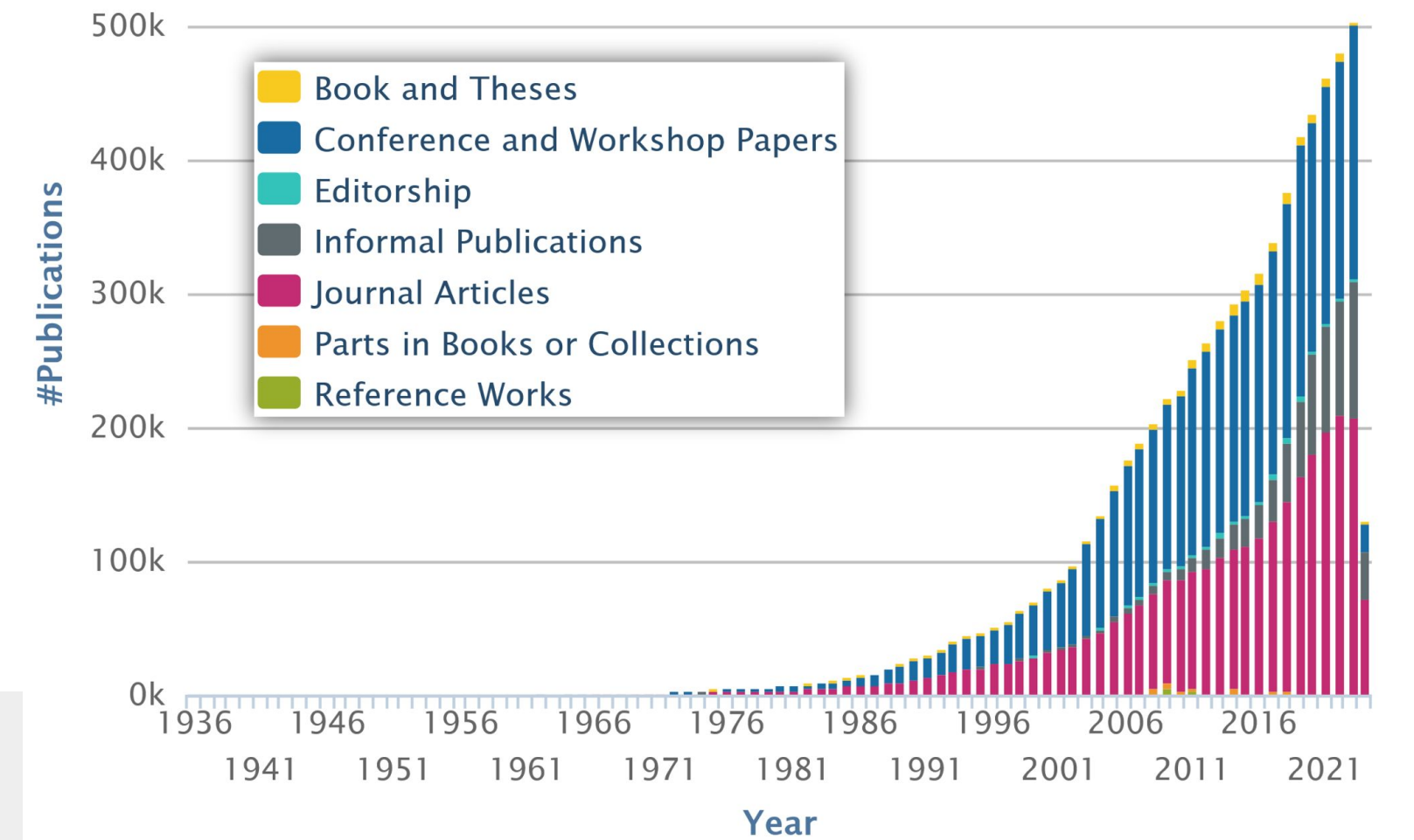
Department of Informatics,  
University of Zurich, Switzerland



## Motivation

- Exponential increase in the publication of scientific records.
- Automatic annotation systems are crucial for human annotators working at digital libraries to annotate the research papers into classes.
- Our objective is to **classify scientific articles for their respective field of research** of the 123 pre-defined hierarchical classes from the ORKG taxonomy of research fields.

Our method **ranked first** in the shared task Field of Research Classification of Scholarly Publications of the 1st **Workshop on Natural Scientific Language Processing and Research Knowledge Graphs (NSLP 2024)**.



Source: <https://dblp.org/statistics/publicationsperyear.html>

## SLAMFORC System

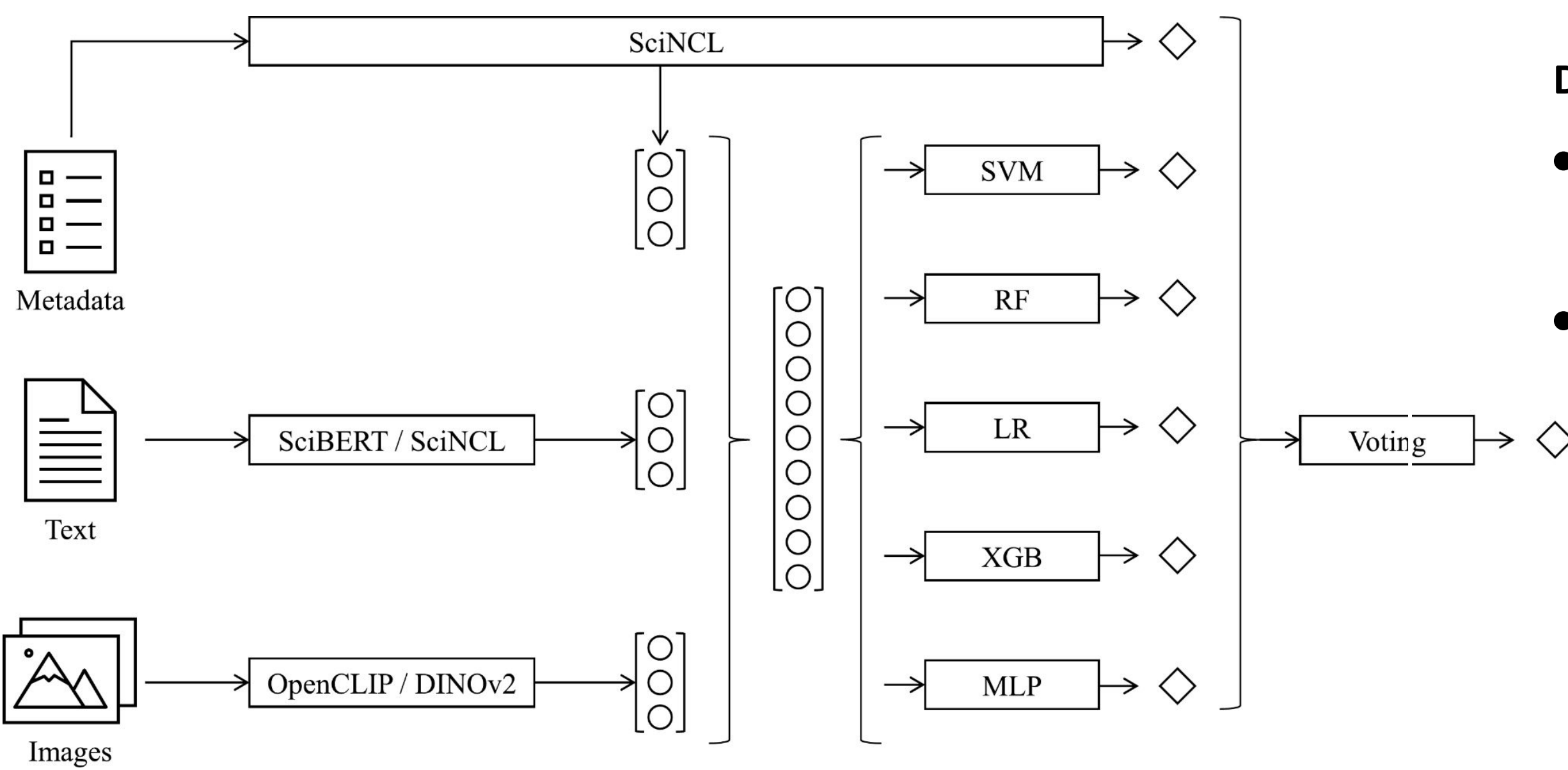


Figure: Overview of the SLAMFORC system showing the integration of multi-modal data and classifiers.

**SLAMFORC System:** mixture of traditional classifiers including SVM, Random Forest, Logistic Regression and eXtreme Gradient Boosting and neural methods including MLP, SciNCL that we combined with an ensemble voting method.

**Note:** SciNCL is a pre-trained BERT language model to generate document-level embeddings of research papers

**Dataset :** 59,500 English scientific papers

- Metadata fields: title, authors, abstract, DOI, URL to the full paper (if available), publisher, publication month, and year
- Classes are 123 fields of research (FoR) across five major domains and four hierarchical levels, with mapping to the ORKG taxonomy

### SLAMFORC System: Multi-Modal Data

- Crossref:** enhance the text data of papers (e.g., retrieved the annotated subjects)
- Metadata:** used title, abstract, and publisher information from given dataset
- Full text:** retrieved full text of document if available using PaperMage [19]
- Visual Information:** OpenCLIP [11] model pre-trained on the LAION-5B dataset [26], a pre-trained DINOv2 [22] model

Table: The final evaluation results on the test set as measured by accuracy, weighted precision, recall, and F1 (best for each in **bold**, runner-up underlined). Our submission is the first line. The F1 scores are sorted in descending order, indicating that higher scores are listed first.

| ID              | Accuracy     | Precision    | Recall       | F1 ↓         |
|-----------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|
| <b>SLAMFORC</b> | <u>0.756</u> | <b>0.757</b> | <u>0.756</u> | <b>0.754</b> |
| 688995          | 0.754        | <u>0.755</u> | <u>0.754</u> | <u>0.752</u> |
| 687946          | <b>0.757</b> | <u>0.754</u> | <b>0.757</b> | <u>0.750</u> |
| 689747          | 0.748        | 0.744        | 0.748        | 0.743        |
| 688510          | 0.743        | 0.742        | 0.743        | 0.739        |
| 651741          | 0.730        | 0.725        | 0.730        | 0.724        |
| 649383          | 0.726        | 0.719        | 0.726        | 0.720        |
| 686435          | 0.706        | 0.703        | 0.706        | 0.693        |
| 686384          | 0.702        | 0.695        | 0.702        | 0.692        |
| 689251          | 0.682        | 0.679        | 0.682        | 0.678        |
| 689454          | 0.658        | 0.659        | 0.658        | 0.653        |
| 647796          | 0.058        | 0.061        | 0.058        | 0.057        |
| 678150          | 0.004        | 0.002        | 0.004        | 0.002        |

## Results

- Our system achieved the **highest precision and F1** and the **second-best accuracy and recall** values of all submissions.
- Our feature ablation study indicates that the meta information is more contributing towards the classification.
- Our combined approach is better than the end-to-end LLM (SciNCL) solution on only the metadata.
- We trained several SOTA classifiers that could handle vectors as input and predict the single-label class as outcome.

Table: Ablation Study Results.

| Classifier             | Accuracy | Precision | Recall | F1    |
|------------------------|----------|-----------|--------|-------|
| Support Vector Machine | 0.755    | 0.754     | 0.755  | 0.752 |
| Random Forest          | 0.755    | 0.754     | 0.755  | 0.753 |
| Logistic Regression    | 0.750    | 0.755     | 0.750  | 0.750 |
| XGBoost                | 0.731    | 0.735     | 0.731  | 0.731 |
| Multilayer Perceptron  | 0.743    | 0.748     | 0.743  | 0.743 |

### Concluding Remarks:

- Evaluation Method: need an evaluation metric that integrates semantic analysis within the taxonomy to better understand system performance and address misclassifications.

More Info: FoRC: Field of Research Classification of Scholarly Publications ([Subtask I](#))  
Workshop: <https://github.com/NFDI4DS/nslp2024/tree/main>